1 • IDENTIFY

PROBLEM STATEMENT

We are working together to find an innovative solution to help protect forests and the animals that depend on them.

Mahdi

Photo of the problem

Taken in class, 25 September

Glue photo here
4.9 × 4.1 in

Why it matters

Habitat destruction: animals lose their homes and food when trees are cut down.
Soil erosion: without tree roots, rain washes the soil away.
Disrupted food chains: when species lose their food, others struggle.
Loss of pollinators: forests find it harder to grow back.

Mahdi

Source 1

National Geographic Education · "Deforestation"

To add: what it told us · Mahdi + Ammar

Mahdi

Source 2

WWF · "Deforestation and forest degradation"

To add: what it told us · Mahdi + Ammar

Mahdi

Source 3

World Health Organization · "Biodiversity" fact sheet

To add: what it told us · Mahdi + Ammar

Mahdi

Our expert

Mr. Hussain

Glue photo here
2.9 × 2.2 in

The expert we talked to

Our expert, Mr. Hussain, told us forests are cut down to build roads, homes, malls and supermarkets, and for wood to build houses and to cook.

To add: his job · Mahdi

Ammar · Mahdi

2 • DESIGN

Our project plan

- **25 Sep** Picked deforestation. Photographed the problem.
- **9 Oct** Board day: first drafts, sources written down.
- **24 Oct** Presented at the scrimmage, Montverde Academy.
- **30 Oct** Mock interviews. Talking points and board draft.
- **13 Nov** Full rounds. Built this board.
- **5 Dec** Qualifier.

To add to the line: dates we talked to our expert, shared with the Red team, ran the survey · Mahdi + Ammar

Abbas

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Abbas: to add"

Ali

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Ali: to add"

Mohamed

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Mohamed: to add"

Husayn

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Husayn: to add"

Haider

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Haider: to add"

Elias

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Elias: to add"

Mahdi

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Mahdi: to add"

Ammar

Glue photo here
2.2 × 2.1 in

"Ammar: to add"

Ctrl + Alt + Defeat

INNOVATION PROJECT

Our problem: **DEFORESTATION** · WISE Academy · Orlando, Florida · FIRST LEGO League Challenge · BIOGLOW 2026–27

3 · CREATE

OUR SOLUTION: *name · Mahdi + Ammar decide*

When a tree has to come down, plant two new trees for every one, before the cutting starts. Where you can, cut it only halfway and leave the trunk standing, so animals still have a home while the new trees grow.

Our solution, drawn and labelled

Arrows point at each part

Glue the drawing here
15.8 × 13 in

How it works · 1 · Before cutting

Plant two new trees for every tree that has to come down.

Companies that cut trees for wood and houses carry seeds and plant new ones every time they cut.

Mahdi

How it works · 2 · When cutting

Where you can, cut it only halfway and leave the trunk standing.

How it works · 3 · While they grow

Animals still have a home in the trunk while the new trees grow.

What already exists → What we made, and what is new

WHAT ALREADY EXISTS		WHAT WE MADE, AND WHAT IS NEW
People plant trees back after they cut.	→	**Two new trees for every one, planted before the cutting starts.**
People protest and ask builders to stop.	→	**Something hands-on: if you cut a tree, you plant more.**
Whole trees are cut down.	→	**Cut only halfway. The trunk left standing is still a home for animals. Cutting half is a new idea our whole team discussed.**

Mahdi · Ammar

4 • ITERATE

Shared with #1
The Red team

To add: date · Ammar

Ammar · Mahdi

Shared with #2
Our expert, Mr. Hussain

To add: date · Mahdi

Ammar · Mahdi

Shared with #3
Judges at the scrimmage
Sat 24 Oct · Montverde Academy

What they said #1
To add: Red team's words + name · Elias

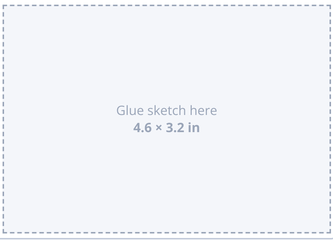
What they said #2
“If you cut a tree halfway, animals can use what's left as a home.”
— our expert, Mr. Hussain

Mahdi

What they said #3
To add: a judge's words · Elias

BEFORE
Cut the whole tree and plant more.

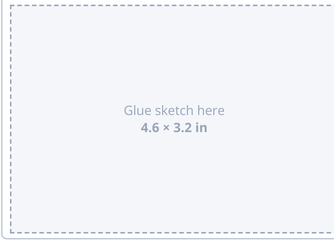
Mahdi



→

AFTER
Also cut only halfway: animals can use what's left as a home.

Mahdi



The change we made from feedback: Our expert said a half-cut tree is still a home, so we added cutting only halfway.

Mahdi

5 • COMMUNICATE

Who it helps
Animals and plants · Local communities · Farmers · Future generations

Mahdi

What changes for them
Protects animal habitats and biodiversity, so animals don't lose their homes.

Mahdi

TEAM PHOTO
All eight of us

